

Subject Description Form

Subject Code	ITC4208M
Subject Title	Luxury Fashion Management
Credit Value	3
Level	4
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Pre-requisite: ITC2013M Fashion Marketing Exclusion: SFT340E Luxury Fashion Marketing and Management
Objectives	The subject provides an overview of the luxury fashion industry and the brand and marketing management process for the luxury fashion goods and experiential luxury industry, both with respect from consumer and managerial perspectives.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: (a) build the foundational knowledge of the luxury industry (b) understand the fundamentals to luxury fashion branding and marketing (c) analyze external and internal trends affecting the luxury fashion business (d) identify key problems inherent in the current luxury fashion marketplaces/brands (e) make strategic choices to solve the problems, for instance, by developing new brand management strategies or by proposing/developing new products (e.g., lifestyle products) (f) nurture professionalism, demonstrate critical/creative thinking skills, and build communication skills and teamwork spirit (g) apply the knowledge acquired in the luxury fashion goods and experiential luxury industry.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	(I) Overview of the luxury fashion industry <i>What is luxury?</i> – Definitions and meanings of luxury – Key characteristics and identifiers of luxury – Hierarchy of, and the histories behind, luxury fashion brands (II) Fundamentals to luxury fashion branding <i>What makes a brand luxury?</i> – The importance of branding to luxury – Seven important brand concepts for developing a luxury fashion brand: from brand concept, brand identity, brand awareness, brand positioning, brand loyalty, to brand equity and brand value

	(III) Challenges in the current luxury fashion marketplaces <i>What are the major challenges facing the luxury industry?</i> - External and internal factors (e.g., digitalization and the growing demand for sustainability) influencing the luxury fashion market - The changing consumer mindset of luxury - The subsequent ups and downs of luxury fashion brands (IV) Principles of luxury fashion brand management <i>How can luxury brands sustain or create brand equity?</i> - Identifying luxury fashion brands' positioning, values, and DNAs - Applying the innovation, product design and creativity to planning and implementing new brand/marketing programs (including new accessories or lifestyle product developments or experiential luxury) for the brands to sustain/grow brand equity (V) Essentials to luxury fashion marketing <i>How can luxury brands create the highest brand value?</i> - Luxury clienteling elements and target consumer analysis - The 6Ps of luxury fashion marketing: product, pricing, place, promotion, people, and positioning
Teaching/Learning Methodology	<i>Lectures</i> will be used to deliver the theories and concepts. Current issues in luxury markets and branding will be used to demonstrate the reality in the marketplace with a local, regional and global perspective. <i>Tutorials</i> will be employed to further explore, enhance and deepen the learning process and knowledge gained. <i>Quizzes</i> will be employed to help students gauge their understanding of the subject topics and concepts. <i>Guest speakers</i> from the industry will be invited to share and update the students' knowledge. <i>Group/individual assignments</i> will be set to take the students through the entire strategic conception, planning & implementation process in Luxury Fashion Marketing and Management, so as to develop ways for luxury brands to maintain/grow their brand equity in a highly competitive and fast changing business environment. This exercise will assess the skills of the group in strategic thinking, analytical and creative ability. It will also test the 'soft skills' of the team members in group dynamics and interaction, time management, and their communication and presentation skills.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)						
			a	b	c	d	e	f	g
	Continuous Assessment	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	<i>1. Group assignment</i>	25%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	<i>2. Individual assignment</i>	15%	✓	✓	✓	✓			
	<i>3. Quizzes</i>	10%	✓	✓					
	Examination	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓			
	Total	100%							
Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: <i>Group assignments</i> will require the team members to employ their critical thinking and analytical ability to solve the brief, with creativity and innovativeness. They will learn and improve their “soft skills”, including teamwork, group dynamics, supplement of each others’ strengths and weaknesses, leadership, time and project management, as well as communication and presentation skills. <i>Individual assignments</i> will require the students to read widely and improve their research and writing skills, so that they may write up their findings in a logical and rational manner. <i>Tutorials</i> will enable the students to look at real life examples of successful/unsuccessful brands in the luxury fashion industry and to discuss the significant attributes of the brands and evaluate their management practices.									
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:								
	• Lectures					26 Hrs.			
	• Tutorial					12 Hrs.			
	Other student study effort:								
	• Individual & Group Assignments					57 Hrs.			
	• Self-Reading					10 Hrs.			
	Total student study effort					105 Hrs.			

Reading List and References

Essentials

Okonkwo, U. (2016). *Luxury fashion branding: trends, tactics, techniques*. Springer.

Berghaus, B., Müller-Stewens, G., & Reinecke, S. (Eds.). (2018). *The management of luxury: An international guide*. Kogan Page Publishers.

Kapferer, J. N., & Bastien, V. (2012). *The luxury strategy: Break the rules of marketing to build luxury brands*. Kogan page publishers.

Recommended

Sudbury-Riley, L., Hunter-Jones, P., Al-Abdin, A., Lewin, D., & Spence, R. (2020). Conceptualizing experiential luxury in palliative care: Pathographies of liminal space, cathedral, and community. *Journal of Business Research*, 116, 446-457.

Keller, K. L. (2017). Managing the growth tradeoff: Challenges and opportunities in luxury branding. *Advances in Luxury Brand management*, 179-198.

Chevalier, M. & Gutsatz, M. (2012), *Luxury Retail Management*, Wiley.

Journals

Journal of Business Research

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Website

WGSN: www.wgsn.com

WWD: www.wwd.com

Business of fashion: www.businessoffashion.com